

Roland AIRA Compact P-6 — Cheat Sheet

Creative phrase sampler, part of Roland's AIRA Compact series. Battery-powered, 48-sample memory, 16-voice sample playback + 4-voice granular.

Top Panel Layout

Section	Controls
Display / Common	4-digit LED display, TEMPO/VALUE knob, SHIFT, PATTERN, Play, Record
Effects	CTRL1–CTRL3 knobs, LOOPER, PITCH (FX), DELAY, FILTER, SCATTER, MFX (master effect on/off)
Sample Edit	PITCH, START, END, LEVEL knobs; SAMPLING, LO-FI, GATE, DELETE, LOOP buttons
Banks	A/E–D/H bank select buttons (4 banks × 2 = 8 groups of 6 pads → 48 samples)
Pads & Keys	Pads 1–6, GRANULAR pad, step/keyboard buttons, KYBD (keyboard mode)
Rear/Top jacks	CHARGE indicator, SYNC IN/OUT, MIX IN, MIX OUT/HEADSET, VOLUME knob, USB-C

Sampling Workflow

1. Press **[SAMPLING]** — button lights, ready to sample.
2. Select an **empty (blinking)** pad — occupied pads can't be selected; delete the existing sample first if needed.
3. Press **[SAMPLING]** again to start recording (pad lights, SAMPLING blinks).
4. Press **[SAMPLING]** once more to stop.
5. Device auto-processes the sample: displays `nor÷` (normalizing) → `donE` when finished.

Step sampling: automatically divides one long recording into equal segments across multiple pads — useful for chopping a beat or vocal phrase in one pass.

Sample Edit Knobs (context-dependent)

The four knobs re-map depending on the current edit page:

Page	PITCH	START	END	LEVEL
Top / normal	Coarse tune	Start point	End point	Sample level
P.ENV (pitch envelope)	Attack	Decay	Sustain	Release
Voice (tone envelope)	Attack	Decay	Sustain	Release
Granular mode	—	Grain position/spread	Grain size	Level
Filter	Cutoff	Resonance	Env depth	Level
Mixer	Pan	Delay send	Reverb send	Level

CTRL1–CTRL3 always control the active effect's parameters (or Delay/Reverb time & level).

Key Buttons & Shift Combos

Action	Result
LOOP	Toggle sample looping

SHIFT + LOOP	Cycle playback direction: forward → reverse → alternate
GATE	Toggle gate (one-shot) playback mode
SHIFT + GATE	Switch sample between monophonic and polyphonic
LO-FI	Toggle Lo-Fi degradation on the sample
DELETE	Delete the selected sample (frees the pad)
GRANULAR pad	Engage granular playback/synthesis on a sample
KYBD	Play pads chromatically like a keyboard
PATTERN	Enter pattern select / management mode
SHIFT + QUANTIZE	Toggle real-time input quantization

Sequencer / Pattern

- Step & real-time recording of patterns per pad.
- **Step input:** press step buttons to place triggers; hold a step button while turning **PITCH/START/END/LEVEL** to record a "motion" (parameter lock) into that step.
- Supports tie input, note copy/paste/insert, and editing individual steps.
- Patterns are organized per bank/pad group and can be chained via PATTERN mode.

Effects (MFX) — 20 Types

Effect	Key Parameters
DJFX Looper	Length, Speed, Loop SW
Chromatic PS	Pitch 1/2, Balance, Pan 1/2
Sync Delay	Time, Feedback, Level, Damp (Low/High)
Filter + Drive	Cutoff, Resonance, Drive, Filter type, Low freq/gain
Scatter	Type, Depth, Scatter, Speed
Isolator	Low, Mid, High
Resonator	Root, Bright, Feedback, Chord, Panning, Env mod
Stopper	Depth, Rate, Resonance, Filter mod, Amp mod
Super Filter	Cutoff, Resonance, Filter type, Depth, Rate, Sync
Vinyl Sim	Frequency, Noise, Wow/Flutter
Cassette Sim	Tone, Hiss, Age, Drive, Wow/Flutter, Catch
Lo-Fi	Pre-filter, Lo-Fi type, Tone, Cutoff, Balance, Level
Reverb	Type, Time, Level, Low/High cut, Pre-delay
Chorus	Depth, Rate, Balance, EQ low/high, Level
Flanger	Depth, Rate, Manual, Resonance, Balance, Sync
Phaser	Depth, Rate, Manual, Resonance, Balance, Sync

Tremolo/Pan	Depth, Rate, Type, Wave, Sync
Ring Mod	Frequency, Sens, Balance, Polarity, EQ low/high
Crusher	Filter, Rate, Balance
Compressor	Sustain, Attack, Ratio, Level

Dedicated one-touch effect buttons: **LOOPER, PITCH, DELAY, FILTER, SCATTER**; **MXF** enables/disables the full multi-effect chain. CTRL1–3 shape whichever effect is active.

Connectivity

- **SYNC IN / OUT** — mini-jack sync with other AIRA Compact / Pocket Operator-style gear
- **MIX IN** — blend external audio into the master mix
- **MIX OUT/HEADSET** — stereo out, doubles as headphone jack (CTIA stereo)
- **USB-C** — audio + MIDI over USB, plus charging
- **MIDI over USB** — connect to DAWs/computers; full MIDI implementation in the manual

Specs at a Glance

Spec	Value
Max samples	48
Max sample time	~23.7 sec (mono, 11.025 kHz)
Import format	WAV (Linear PCM)
Internal mic	Mono x 1
Polyphony	16 voices (sample), 4 voices (granular)
Effects	20 multi-effect types + delay/reverb sends
Power	Li-ion battery, ~3 hrs use, ~3 hrs charge via USB-C, 500 mA draw
Dimensions	188 (W) × 106 (D) × 37 (H) mm
Weight	305 g (with battery)

Quick Tips

- Occupied pads must be **DELETED** before re-sampling into them.
- Use **SHIFT + GATE** to make chords/layers possible on a single sample (polyphonic).
- **Motion recording**: hold a step + twist a knob to automate filter/pitch/level sweeps per step.
- GRANULAR pad turns any sample into a texture/pad source — great for stretching short clips.
- SYNC IN/OUT lets you clock-sync multiple AIRA Compact units without MIDI cables.

Source: Roland official P-6 Owner's Manual (static.roland.com/manuals/p-6/en-US)